Day Trader Skill: The Complete Setup Guide

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What this is

The Day Trader skill is a free pack of 11 Claude skills that does a day trader's research for you: it scans thousands of charts, tracks the news, times the entry, plans the exit and replays the trade 10,000 times before you risk a rupee or a dollar. This is the exclusive setup guide from **@swapsays_wtf** that I promised in the reel: everything from install to your first full trade plan.

- **Repo:** github.com/Jakeschincariol/day-trader-skill, made by Jake Schincariol. It calls itself "the Trader skill v2".
- **Cost:** free, MIT licence, no signup, no API key.
- **Data:** free public sources only. Yahoo Finance charts, Nasdaq Trader's symbol lists, SEC EDGAR and the US House Clerk.
- **Market:** US stocks (NYSE and Nasdaq listings, about 5,900 of them). Prices and times are in New York time.
- **Safety:** nothing in the pack can place an order on its own. Paper trading is the default, and a real order needs your typed yes.

Who it is for: anyone curious about day trading who wants a disciplined, rule-based process instead of tips. It is a research and planning tool, not a money machine. Read the fine print at the end before you use real money.

Before you start

You need three things: Claude Code, Python 3.8 or newer, and your name and email for the SEC data feeds. Setup takes about ten minutes.

What	Why	How to check
Claude Code (the Code tab in the Claude desktop app, or `claude` in a terminal)	The skills run small Python tools on your computer, so they need Claude Code, not the plain chat	Open the Code tab, or type `claude --version` in a terminal
Python 3.8+	Every tool is plain Python with nothing to pip install	`python3 --version`

What	Why	How to check
git	To download the repo if you install by hand	`git --version`
Your name and email	SEC EDGAR asks every visitor to identify themselves (used by the news and earnings skills)	You add it once to `trader/config.json`
A broker account (optional)	Only if you later want Claude to send orders. Paper trading first	See "Connecting a broker safely"

No Claude Code? You can paste any single `SKILL.md` file at the top of a normal Claude chat and it works as a mode. You lose the Python tools, so Claude cannot fetch live data, but the method still guides you.

Checklist before you install

- [ ] Claude Code opens and you are signed in
- [ ] `python3 --version` prints 3.8 or higher
- [ ] You have picked a project folder for your trading files (everything the skills write lands in a `trader/` folder inside it)
- [ ] You have decided your practice budget and the most you are willing to lose on one trade

Install

The fastest way is the one from the reel: paste the repo link into Claude and ask it to install the skill. Pick one of the three ways below; all of them give you the same 11 skills.

Way 1: paste the link (easiest). Open Claude Code in your project folder and send exactly this:

```
https://github.com/Jakeschincariol/day-trader-skill

install skill
```

Claude downloads the repo and sets up the skills. Approve the steps it asks about.

Way 2: as a plugin in Claude Code. Run these two commands inside Claude Code:

```
/plugin marketplace add Jakeschincariol/day-trader-skill
/plugin install day-trader-skill@day-trader-skill
```

Plugin skills get a prefix, so they show up as `/day-trader-skill:trader-scanner` and so on.

Way 3: copy the folders by hand. In a terminal:

```
git clone https://github.com/Jakeschincariol/day-trader-skill.git
cp -r day-trader-skill/trader-* ~/.claude/skills/
```

This gives you the short names (`/trader-scanner`, `/trader-news`…) in every project. For one project only, copy the folders into that project's `.claude/skills/` instead.

Then add your SEC identity (one time). Create `trader/config.json` in your project with your own name and email:

```
{ "sec_user_agent": "Your Name you@example.com" }
```

Or set an environment variable instead: `SEC_USER_AGENT="Your Name you@example.com"`. The full list of rules you can set (budget, max loss, trading window) is in `trader-budget/config.example.json`; step 6 of the first-trade walkthrough explains the important ones.

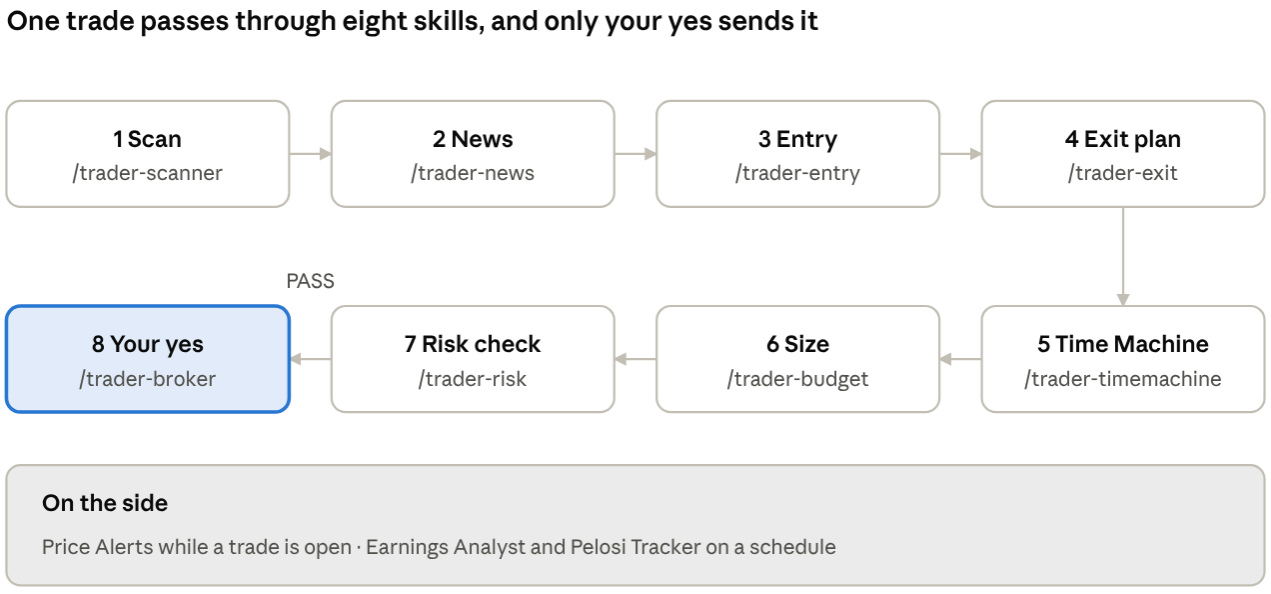
Check it worked. In Claude Code, type `/trader` and you should see the 11 commands in the list. Then ask: *"Is the US market open right now?"* The Price Alerts skill answers with the NYSE hours.

The 11 skills

Eight skills take one trade from idea to order, in a fixed order, and three run on the side. Each one writes its result into the `trader/` folder, and the next one reads it, so you rarely retype anything.

#	Command	Name	What it does
1	`/trader-scanner`	Chart Scanner	Scans thousands of US charts for setups: opening-range breakouts, flags, oversold bounces
2	`/trader-news`	News Monitor	Pulls the latest headlines and SEC 8-K filings for your stocks and flags what moves them
3	`/trader-entry`	Entry Timer	Watches a setup bar by bar and tells you the moment to get in

#	Command	Name	What it does
4	`/trader-exit`	Exit Planner	Sets your stop and your target before you enter
5	`/trader-timemachine`	Time Machine	Replays the rest of the day 10,000 times, plus every past day the same setup fired
6	`/trader-budget`	Budget Manager	Sizes the position to your budget and your max loss per trade
7	`/trader-risk`	Risk Manager	Checks the order against your limits: PASS or BLOCK, with the reason
8	`/trader-broker`	Order Executor	Sends an approved order to your broker, paper by default, never without your yes
9	`/trader-alerts`	Price Alerts	Rings when a price, your stop, your target or the opening bell hits
10	`/trader-analyst`	Earnings Analyst	Reads a company's SEC filings and sums up what changed quarter by quarter
11	`/trader-pelosi`	Pelosi Tracker	Reads US Congress members' stock-trade disclosures the moment they are filed



how one trade flows through the skills · 8 steps

Each step writes a file the next one reads; a BLOCK from the risk check stops the order before it ever reaches you.

You do not have to type the commands. Plain English works too: *"scan the market for breakouts"* or *"how many shares should I buy?"* triggers the right skill.

Your first trade, step by step

One trade runs through eight skills in order: scan, news, entry, exit, Time Machine, size, risk check, broker. Below is the exact trade from my reel, AAPL on Wednesday 21 October 2026, run with the repo's own tools on real data. Times are New York time; the US market is open 9:30 AM to 4:00 PM (7:00 PM to 1:30 AM in India; 8:00 PM to 2:30 AM after the US clocks go back in November).

1. **Scan for setups.** At about 10:00 AM, ask: *"Scan the market for opening-range breakouts."*
   - The scanner checked 5,942 charts. Of the 200 most-traded, 109 had closed above their 15-minute opening range by 10:56 AM, and AAPL was one of them.
   - It saves the list to `trader/watchlist.json`. A scan is a list of charts that match a rule, not a list of stocks to buy.
2. **Check the news.** Ask: *"Any news on AAPL?"*
   - It shows only what is new, newest first: Yahoo Finance headlines, SEC 8-K filings and how far the stock is from yesterday's close.
   - That morning's AAPL headlines included "Apple's iPhone Supply Chain Risk Spells Trouble for This Semiconductor Stock" (10:19 AM). Headlines are leads; open the story before acting on one.
3. **Time the entry.** Ask: *"Watch AAPL and tell me when to get in."*
   - AAPL's opening range (9:30 to 9:45) was $338.83 to $341.19.
   - The 10:50 bar closed at $341.85, above the range, so it said TRIGGERED at 10:55 AM. A price that only pokes above the line mid-bar does not count; the bar has to close above it.
4. **Plan the exit before you enter.** Ask: *"Set my stop and target."*
   - Stop: $340.01, the middle of the opening range. Risk: $1.84 a share.
   - Target: $343.69, one times the risk ("1R"). The tool's default is 2R; ask for 1R if you want the closer target.
   - Flat by 3:55 PM: no overnight holds.
5. **Run the Time Machine.** Ask: *"Run the time machine on this trade."* It replayed the rest of the day 10,000 times and said: close to a coin flip (the next section explains how to read it).
6. **Size the position.** Ask: *"I have $5,000 and I only want to risk $50 a trade. How many shares?"*

- It answered 10 shares ($3,418.50). The loss at the stop would be $18.40.
- It wrote one bracket order to `trader/orders.json`: buy 10 AAPL, stop-loss $340.01, take-profit $343.69. Nothing was placed.
- Set your own rules once in `trader/config.json`: `budget`, `max_loss_per_trade_usd`, `max_daily_loss_usd`, `max_trades_per_day`, `no_entries_before` / `no_entries_after`, `flat_by`, and `paper: true`.

7. **Risk check.** Ask: *"Check my order."* It tests the order against every limit (stop present, max loss, daily loss, trades per day, reward-to-risk, entry window, cash) and prints PASS or BLOCK with the reason. A BLOCK is final for that order.
8. **Send it, only if you want to.** Ask: *"Place the order."* The broker skill shows a plain ticket, waits for you to type yes for that exact order, and then Claude's own Allow once / Deny card asks again. Skip this step completely if you only want the research.

What really happened that day: AAPL touched the 1R target at about 11:00 AM. One good day proves nothing, which is exactly why the Time Machine exists.

The Time Machine explained

The Time Machine answers one question before you risk money: if today plays out like this stock's last 60 days, how often does my plan hit the target first, the stop first, or neither? It answers in two ways, a simulation and real history, and you should read both.

How it works

- It keeps only full trading days from the last 60 days of 5-minute bars (59 sessions for AAPL).
- One replay starts at your entry price and builds the rest of the day bar by bar, each bar copied from the same time of day on a random past session.
- It does that 10,000 times with a fixed seed (19), so anyone running the same plan gets the same numbers.
- Then it runs your exact rule on every one of those past days. That part is not a simulation; it is what really happened.

The AAPL result (1R plan, flat by 3:55 PM)

Outcome	Share of 10,000 replays
Target hit first	45.7%
Stop hit first	47.0%
Still open at 3:55 PM	7.3%

- Price at 3:55 PM: median $341.98, with 90% of replays between $337.29 and $346.69.
- Average result: -0.011R (R = the $1.84 risk per share), basically zero.
- History: on the 59 real sessions the rule fired 30 times, with 15 hitting the target, 10 the stop and 5 neither.
- Verdict: **"Close to a coin flip."**

How to read the verdict

- A 1R target must come first in 50% of the replays that hit a side to break even; a 2R target only 33%; 3R 25%.
- Within 5 points of break-even it says "close to a coin flip" (1R) or "close to break-even" (other R). 5 to 15 points off it says "leans toward" the target or the stop; more than that, "strongly toward".
- If replays and history disagree, trust neither blindly. A coin flip is an honest answer; it tells you this setup has no clear edge today.

It is a reality check, not a prediction. An earnings report, a halt or a big headline can do things those 60 days never did, so always check `/trader-news` too.

Connecting a broker safely

You do not need a broker to use 10 of the 11 skills; connect one only when your plans have worked on paper for a while. Even then, an order reaches the market only after three separate gates, every time:

1. `/trader-risk` passed that exact order today.
2. You typed an explicit yes for that one order in the chat. "Sure" or "yes to all" does not count.
3. You clicked **Allow once** on Claude's own permission card.

Option A: Alpaca, paper account (the repo's default)

1. Make an Alpaca account and create **paper trading** API keys in the Alpaca dashboard. Paper keys are separate from live keys.
2. Install `uv` from docs.astral.sh/uv (it provides the `uvx` command).
3. In the Claude desktop app: Settings > Developer > Edit Config. Add this block to `claude_desktop_config.json` and type your own keys **into the file only**:

```
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "alpaca": {
      "command": "uvx",
      "args": ["alpaca-mcp-server"],
      "env": {
        "ALPACA_API_KEY": "your paper key, typed here",
        "ALPACA_SECRET_KEY": "your paper secret, typed here",
        "ALPACA_PAPER_TRADE": "true",
        "ALPACA_TOOLSETS": "account,trading,stock-data"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

4. Restart Claude. Then open Customize > Connectors > alpaca and set the tool permissions:
   - `place_stock_order`, and every tool that cancels, replaces or closes: **Needs approval**. Never Always allow.
   - Options, crypto, "close all" and "cancel all" tools: **Blocked**.
   - Read-only tools (account info, positions, quotes): Always allow is fine.
5. Test it: ask *"Show my Alpaca account info"* and confirm in the Alpaca dashboard that it is the paper account.

Option B: Interactive Brokers. Add the verified Interactive Brokers connector from Customize > Connectors > Browse connectors and sign in there, never in the chat. IBKR receives orders as drafts you approve in IBKR itself. Set `"broker": "ibkr"` in `trader/config.json`.

Never paste an API key, password or account number into the chat. If you ever do by mistake, delete the message and make new keys in your broker's dashboard.

Your daily routine

A trading day with this pack has four parts: prepare before the bell, find and plan one trade after 9:45 AM, let alerts watch it, and be flat by 3:55 PM. Times below are New York (India time in brackets, before the November clock change).

When	What to ask Claude	Skill
Before 9:30 AM (before 7:00 PM IST)	"Pre-market scan" for 20-day breakouts, bull flags and oversold bounces	Chart Scanner
Before 9:30 AM	"Morning briefing on my watchlist"	News Monitor
Before 9:30 AM	"Does AAPL report earnings this week? How did the last quarter look?"	Earnings Analyst
9:45 to 10:30 AM (7:15 to 8:00 PM IST)	"Scan for opening-range breakouts", then the entry, exit, Time Machine, size and risk steps	Scanner to Risk Manager
While a trade is open	"Watch my trade": alerts on the stop, the target and 3:55 PM	Price Alerts
3:55 PM (1:25 AM IST)	"Flatten my position" for anything still open	Order Executor
Weekly	"What is Pelosi buying?" or "Any new Congress trades in stocks I hold?"	Pelosi Tracker

The three side skills in more detail

- **Price Alerts** turns your plan into three alerts at once (stop, target, flat by close) and also handles price levels, percent moves and the NYSE opening bell, with 2026 and 2027 holidays and half days built in. An alert is information only; it never sells anything.
- **Earnings Analyst** reads revenue, margins, net income and EPS straight from the company's SEC filings, compares each quarter with the same quarter a year earlier, and can read an earnings-call transcript you paste in. Use it before trading a stock near its report date.
- **Pelosi Tracker** reads the US House Clerk's public trade reports as soon as they are posted and turns each PDF into clean rows: who, stock, buy or sell, date and amount range. These filings arrive up to 45 days after the trade, so they are fast to read but never early.

My rule of thumb: one setup, one plan, one trade a day while you learn. The pack enforces this if you set `max_trades_per_day` to 1.

Prompts to copy

Paste these into Claude Code as they are; swap AAPL and the dollar amounts for your own.

Setup

```
https://github.com/Jakeschincariol/day-trader-skill

install skill
```

```
Set my trading rules: $5,000 budget, max $50 loss per trade, max $150 loss per day, 1 trade per day, paper trading only, flat by 3:55 PM.
```

One full trade

```
Scan the market for opening-range breakouts and show me the top 10.
```

```
Any news on AAPL in the last 12 hours? Does it report earnings this week?
```

```
Watch AAPL bar by bar and tell me the moment the opening-range breakout triggers.
```

```
Set my stop at the opening-range midpoint and my target at 1R. Flat by 3:55 PM.
```

```
Run the time machine on this plan and tell me the odds in plain words.
```

```
How many shares should I buy with my rules? Then run the risk check.
```

While it is open

```
Watch my trade: alert me at the stop, the target and at 3:55 PM.
```

Research on the side

```
How did Apple's last quarter look? What changed compared to a year ago?
```

```
What has Nancy Pelosi bought or sold this year? Flag anything I hold.
```

Troubleshooting and FAQ

Most problems are one of five things: the skills are not installed where Claude looks, Python cannot reach the internet securely, the SEC identity is missing, Yahoo is rate-limiting you, or the market is closed.

What you see	What it means	Fix
`/trader` shows no commands	Skills are not in a folder Claude reads	Re-run the install, or check that `~/.claude/skills/trader-scanner/SKILL.md` exists. Restart Claude Code
"Yahoo did not answer … CERTIFICATE_VERIFY_FAILED" (Mac)	Python from python.org has no certificates installed	Run "Install Certificates.command" from your Python folder in Applications, or start Claude Code with `SSL_CERT_FILE=/etc/ssl/cert.pem`
"SEC filings skipped: set sec_user_agent"	The news and earnings tools need your name and email	Add `"sec_user_agent": "Your Name you@example.com"` to `trader/config.json`
"Yahoo did not answer, wait a minute"	Free data, rate-limited	Wait a minute and ask again. A full scan of ~5,900 charts takes several minutes
Entry says "not open yet" or "expired"	Market closed, or past the last entry time (3:30 PM by default)	Run it between 9:45 AM and 3:30 PM New York time
Time Machine refuses	Fewer than 20 full sessions, or the entry bar is not in the data	Use a liquid US stock and run it after the entry bar has closed
Risk check says BLOCK	The order breaks one of your rules (the reason is printed)	Fix the plan or change the rule in `trader/config.json` on purpose, never to force a trade

FAQ

- **Is it really free?** Yes. MIT licence, free public data, no API key. A broker account is separate and optional.

- **Does it work for Indian stocks (NSE/BSE)?** No. It is built for US-listed stocks and New York trading hours.
- **Can it trade automatically while I sleep?** No, by design. Every order needs your typed yes and a click.
- **Is the data real-time?** No. Yahoo's free chart data can lag, and the tools read 1- or 5-minute bars, not every tick. Check prices with your broker before acting.
- **What is the $25,000 pattern-day-trader rule?** The README says FINRA removed it on 4 June 2026, but brokers may phase the change in until 20 October 2027. If yours still applies it, set `"pdt_guard": true`.

Fine print

This guide shows how to use a free tool; it is not financial advice, and most people who day trade lose money. Read these before you put real money anywhere.

- **Not advice.** The pack reads public data and does arithmetic. It does not know your situation and cannot see the future. Talk to a licensed professional if you need advice.
- **Paper first.** `"paper": true` is the default. Stay on paper until you have followed the full process for weeks.
- **The Time Machine is a simulation.** Its odds come from the last 60 days of one stock and are a reality check, never a promise.
- **A stop is a plan, not a guarantee.** In a fast market or across a gap, a stop can fill well below its price. The max loss shown is the loss at the stop price.
- **Free data is unofficial.** Yahoo's chart endpoint can lag, change or rate-limit. Check anything that matters against your broker.
- **Congress trades are public filings,** not inside information, and they arrive up to 45 days late.
- **Taxes.** Day-trading gains are short-term gains, and if you trade US stocks from India the foreign-investment and tax rules apply to you. Check with a tax professional.

Sources: Day Trader skill repo and README (MIT, by Jake Schincariol). The AAPL numbers in this guide come from running the repo's own tools on 21 October 2026 data.

Questions? Comment on the reel or DM **@swapsays_wtf**.